HABIT FORMATION

# Atomic Habits

*An Easy & Proven Way to Build Good Habits & Break Bad Ones*

**James Clear · 2018**

James Clear shows how tiny improvements compound into remarkable results, and gives a practical system for designing the cues, cravings and rewards behind every habit you want to build or break.[1,2,9]

WHY READ IT

- A clear, memorable system you can apply to any habit[2]
- Stories from athletes, artists and scientists that make the ideas stick[1]
- Practical tools like habit stacking and the Two-Minute Rule[6,8]

GET THE BOOK

**Atomic Habits** by James Clear

Avery (Penguin Random House), 2018. At your local bookshop, your library, or as an audiobook.

A free guide inspired by *Atomic Habits* by James Clear. Not affiliated with the author or publisher.

THE BIG IDEA

# Systems beat goals

Clear argues that goals set the direction but systems make the progress: you fall to the level of your systems. Getting about 1% better each day compounds, even when results stay invisible for a long time. He calls that stretch the Plateau of Latent Potential.[1,2,3]

THREE LESSONS

1 **Every action is a vote**

Habits shape identity. Decide who you want to become, then prove it to yourself with small wins. Change works best from identity outward.[4]

2 **Environment beats willpower**

Make the cues for good habits obvious and hide the cues for bad ones. The easiest habit is the one already set up for you.[2]

3 **Never miss twice**

Missing once is an accident. Missing twice is the start of a new pattern, so get straight back on track.[10]

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THE FRAMEWORK

# The Four Laws of Behavior Change[2]

Every habit runs through a loop: cue, craving, response, reward. Each law shapes one stage. To break a habit, invert the law.[2]

## 1 Make it obvious

*Cue · invert: make it invisible*

A habit starts with a cue you notice. Decide exactly when and where you'll act.[2,6]

**Try:** I will [behavior] at [time] in [location].[6]

## 2 Make it attractive

*Craving · invert: unattractive*

The more appealing a habit, the more likely you'll do it.[2]

**Try:** Temptation bundling: pair a need with a want.[7]

## 3 Make it easy

*Response · invert: make it difficult*

Reduce friction for good habits and add it to bad ones.[2]

**Try:** Two-Minute Rule: start with a version under two minutes.[8]

## 4 Make it satisfying

*Reward · invert: unsatisfying*

We repeat what feels good straight away.[2]

**Try:** Track it so progress is visible.[10]

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FROM THE BOOK

# Tools to try

## The Habits Scorecard

Clear's exercise for noticing what you already do.[5]

1. List everything you do from the moment you wake up.
2. Mark each habit +, – or = for the person you want to be.
3. Don't change anything yet. Just notice.

## Habit stacking

Clear's formula for linking a new habit to an old one.[6]

1. List habits you already do every day without fail.
2. Pick one that happens at the right time and place.
3. Write it: After [current habit], I will [new habit].
4. Make the cue precise, like “when I close my laptop at lunch”.

MAKE IT YOURS

# Try it this week

1. Do the Habits Scorecard for one ordinary day.
2. Pick one new habit and shrink it to two minutes.
3. Stack it onto an existing habit.
4. Track it every day, and never miss twice.

REFLECT

*Which of your current habits are votes for the person you want to become?*

*What does your current system reliably produce?*

**Try it in Sedi:** Add the stacked habit as a daily Routine in Timely and tick it off to keep your streak visible.

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READ THE BOOK

## Atomic Habits

James Clear · Avery (Penguin Random House) · 2018

This guide only scratches the surface. The book has the research, the stories and the nuance behind every idea here. Buy it from an independent bookshop, borrow it from your library, or listen to the audiobook.

A NOTE FROM ME

I'm not affiliated with James Clear or the publisher, and this guide isn't sponsored or endorsed by them. I've learned a lot from this book, so I'm sharing what I took from it, for free, in case it helps you too. Everything here is my own summary, in my own words. The good ideas are the author's; any mistakes are mine.

*The maker of Sedi*

SOURCES

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